MERCY'S ANATOMY

Document MA-010: Series Focus and Ensemble Format

Canon Lock v2.4. Builds on MA-002, MA-004 and MA-009

STATUS: LOCKED IN. For most of its run, *Mercy's Anatomy* revolves around **Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock** and chronicles his progression from surgical intern to fully qualified doctor. The series uses an **ensemble format**. Marc is the protagonist and the center of gravity, and a large regular cast carries full, independent storylines around him.

1. The Lead and the Ensemble

- **Marc is the series lead.** He is the default narrator (MA-002 §3), the point-of-view character for the show's world, and the owner of the season-long spine: his secret identity, his love story with Esther, his family dream, his rise, and his wealth (C-031).
- **The ensemble is real.** Every Main cast member has their own arcs, their own season goals and their own wins and losses. They are never just support for Marc. The No-Nerf Rule (MA-001 Rule 9) means no one is made weaker to make Marc look stronger.
- **'Most of its run':** Marc is at the center from Season 1 on. As the cast grows and new intern classes arrive (Seasons 9, 14 and 19), the ensemble widens and the focus spreads more evenly, but Marc stays the anchor of the series through the present.

2. Screen-Time Guidelines (Standard Episode)

Strand	Typical share	Notes
Marc-Anthony Bullock	25-30%	Usually the A-story (MA-001 §2). He appears in every episode he is credited in.
The rest of the Main cast	55-65% combined	B- and C-stories rotate, and every Main gets meaningful material every episode.
Recurring and guest characters, patients	10-15%	Patients carry the standalone cases (MA-001 §2) and mirror the regulars' struggles.
Voiceover bookends	~2%	Marc by default, or another season regular.

- **Spotlight rule:** in every season, each Main cast member gets at least one episode where their story is the A-story, and Marc may narrate it or hand the narration to them.
- **Ensemble episodes** (mass casualty, lockdowns, finales) share the A-story across the cast. Marc's thread is still the one the episode closes on.

3. Marc's Progression: Intern to Fully Qualified

This follows the 7-year QGH track (MA-004), then the realistic path to becoming a board-certified pediatric surgeon (his specialty goal).

Season	Academic year	Marc's level	Milestone
1-2	2005-06	Intern (PGY-1)	Day one: Friday, July 1, 2005
3	2006-07	Research Resident I (integrated)	Step 3 and the advancement exam
4	2007-08	Surgical Resident (PGY-2)	First time teaching interns
5	2008-09	Surgical Resident (PGY-3)	Commits to pediatric surgery
6	2009-10	Research Resident II (integrated)	Research presented; the merger
7	2010-11	Senior Resident (PGY-4)	Chief resident race
8	2011-12	Senior / Chief-year Resident (PGY-5)	Residency completed Saturday, June 30, 2012
9-10	2012-14	Pediatric Surgery Fellow, with general surgery attending privileges	Fellowship begins Sunday, July 1, 2012. General Surgery board certification in 2013.
11+	2014-	**Attending Pediatric Surgeon: fully qualified**	Fellowship completed June 30, 2014; Pediatric Surgery boards follow
Later	per episodes	Chief of Pediatrics, then Chief of Surgery	Timing set as episodes are built (his creator-set goals)

Fellowship note: in the US, a pediatric surgeon completes general surgery residency and then a 2-year pediatric surgery fellowship. Marc's fellowship runs at Bullock Sloan, so he stays on screen and in the ensemble.

4. Canon Log Additions

ID	Established fact	Source
C-059	Marc-Anthony Bullock is the series lead. For most of its run the series chronicles his progression from intern to fully qualified doctor.	MA-010
C-060	Ensemble format: Marc carries about 25-30% of a standard episode, and every Main gets at least one A-story spotlight per season.	MA-010 §2
C-061	Marc's path: residency 2005-2012, Pediatric Surgery fellowship 2012-2014 at Bullock Sloan, attending pediatric surgeon from July 1, 2014.	MA-010 §3

END OF MA-010. CANON LOCKED (v2.4). One lead. A whole hospital around him.